

China Daily Brief

Saturday, September 5, 2026

RE: Xi's Sept 24 DC visit takes shape · rare-earth shipments quietly halted · PLA-PACOM theater commanders meet
· Gwangju boycott

THE BOTTOM LINE

Beijing is pairing conciliation with leverage ahead of the Sept. 24 Xi-Trump summit. Xi plans an unusually large CEO delegation to Washington and PLA Eastern Theater commander Yang Zhibin held the first in-person China-US theater-commander meeting since the 2022 Pelosi-triggered freeze, per Reuters and Lianhe Zaobao, even as Reuters reports Chinese rare-earth firms have quietly halted some US shipments and Beijing boycotts a Gwangju art festival over Taiwan naming. Watch: the Sept. 24 Washington visit and the mid-September US-China AI-safety talks Reuters says are being scheduled.

TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 Trump confirmed Xi Jinping's Sept. 24 Washington visit will include a state dinner, while Reuters reports Xi plans to bring a large Chinese CEO delegation, the first such business entourage since 2015.
- 2 Chinese rare-earth producers have quietly halted some shipments to the US over 'geopolitical worries,' Reuters reports, days before the two sides plan mid-September AI-safety talks.
- 3 PLA Eastern Theater Command chief Yang Zhibin held his first bilateral meeting with INDOPACOM's Adm. Samuel Paparo in Victoria, Canada, ending a nearly two-year gap in theater-commander-level China-US military contact.

US-CHINA

Xi reportedly plans large Chinese corporate delegation for Washington visit

Xi Jinping plans to bring a large delegation of Chinese corporate executives on his Sept. 24 Washington visit, Reuters reported Sept. 4 citing two sources, an unusual move given Beijing's own multi-year regulatory crackdown on private enterprise and Washington's scrutiny of Chinese investment. One source said the goal is to signal China's willingness to invest in and build commercial ties with the US ahead of the midterms.

So what: *Confirms the Sept. 24 Washington summit will be business-centric, raising the odds of new Boeing, agriculture or investment announcements.*

Pattern: *Xi last led a comparable delegation to the US in 2015, when the visit produced a \$38 billion, 300-aircraft Boeing order and included Alibaba's Jack Ma and Tencent's Pony Ma; Trump brought 18 executives, including Nvidia's Jensen Huang and Tesla's Elon Musk, on his own May 2026 Beijing trip.*

LIANHE ZAOBAO (VIA REUTERS EXCLUSIVE)

SANCTIONS

Chinese rare-earth firms quietly halt some US shipments

Chinese rare-earth producers have halted some shipments to the United States over 'geopolitical worries,' Reuters reported Sept. 4, citing sources familiar with the matter.

So what: *The halt lands three weeks before the Sept. 24 Xi-Trump summit and ahead of the roughly Nov. 10 deadline when Busan-deal suspensions of the BIS Affiliates Rule and China's Oct. 2025 rare-earth controls are due to lapse absent an extension.*

Pattern: *China's Oct. 9, 2025 rare-earth export-control expansion was suspended for a year under the Busan truce reached Oct. 30, 2025.*

REUTERS

PLA

PLA Eastern Theater commander holds first meeting with PACOM chief

PLA Eastern Theater Command commander Yang Zhibin held his first bilateral meeting with INDOPACOM commander Adm. Samuel Paparo at the 28th Chiefs of Defense Conference Indo-Pacific Armed Forces in Victoria, Canada (Aug. 31-Sept. 2), MND spokesperson Jiang Bin confirmed Sept. 4. The two discussed keeping senior military channels open to reduce miscalculation risk.

So what: *Marks only the second theater-commander-level China-US military contact since Beijing froze such exchanges, and the first in-person one, ahead of the Sept. 24 Xi-Trump summit.*

Pattern: *Beijing suspended military-to-military ties after then-Speaker Nancy Pelosi's August 2022 Taiwan visit; the only prior resumption was a September 2024 video call between PLA Southern Theater commander Wu Yanan and Paparo.*

LIANHE ZAOBAO

CROSS-STRAIT

China boycotts Gwangju Biennale over Taiwan exhibition naming

China is boycotting South Korea's Gwangju Biennale, one of Asia's major contemporary-art festivals, in a dispute over the naming of a Taiwanese exhibition, the Washington Post reported Sept. 4.

So what: Comes alongside WaPo's companion reporting on how Beijing uses global institutions to enforce 'one China' naming conventions on Taiwan.

WASHINGTON POST

DIPLOMACY

China tightens information controls after Tibet-Nepal border flood

China has tightened information controls in Tibet since an Aug. 26 glacier collapse triggered a cross-border flood into Nepal, deploying image-recognition tools to erase viral footage while state media pushed a 'sanitized, triumphant rescue narrative,' the Washington Post and DW reported. Reuters separately reported families of missing pilgrims in Tibet are demanding answers from Beijing.

So what: People's Daily's own Sept. 5 coverage cites 31 dead and 531 missing at the Gyirong (Jilong) border port, figures not prominently amplified domestically.

WASHINGTON POST; REUTERS; DW

US-CHINA

DIPLOMACY · BLOOMBERG

Trump confirms state dinner for Xi's Sept. 24 Washington visit

Trump confirmed Xi Jinping's Sept. 24 Washington visit will include a state dinner, in remarks reported Sept. 4. It will be the first Chinese leader state visit to the US since 2015, reciprocating Trump's May 14-15 Beijing trip.

DIPLOMACY · REUTERS

US, China prepare mid-September AI safety talks

US and Chinese officials are preparing to hold AI-safety talks in mid-September, Reuters reported Sept. 4, citing sources familiar with the planning. The dialogue would run alongside the broader trade normalization track ahead of the Sept. 24 summit.

MILITARY · 德国之声中文 (DW CHINESE)

COSCO denies spying for Beijing after Reuters report

China's COSCO Shipping rejected Reuters reporting, citing two senior US officials, that alleged it uses onboard equipment to collect military communications intelligence, calling the claim 'completely groundless.' China's embassy in Washington said Beijing never asks companies to collect overseas data in violation of local law.

DIPLOMACY · TAIPEI TIMES

Domestic politics, not Taiwan, seen driving Sept. 24 summit agenda

National Chengchi University's Wang Hsin-hsien said the May Beijing summit's 'strategic stability' was closer to 'tactical stability', "like two boxers agreeing to take a break... it is preparation for the next round." He said Trump will likely press for more Boeing, soybean and beef purchases ahead of the midterms while Taiwan gets less attention than in May.

CROSS-STRAIT · TAIPEI TIMES

Taiwan shelters Chinese lawyer who represented detained church leaders

Taiwan's Mainland Affairs Council confirmed it granted 'temporary accommodation on humanitarian grounds' to a Chinese national transiting a Taiwanese airport, after ChinaAid said Zion Church lawyer Ruth Wang fled to Taiwan 'seeking protection.' Church founder Ezra Jin was released in July after Trump raised his case with Xi, but eight detained members remain held.

AUSTRALIA-PACIFIC · WASHINGTON POST

Pacific Islands Forum fails to unite on condemning China missile launch

Pacific Islands Forum leaders could not reach a unanimous statement condemning a Chinese ballistic missile launch, the Washington Post reported, with Palau among those pressing for stronger language. The split shows Beijing's continued ability to divide Pacific nations on security messaging even as it expands regional ties.

MIDDLE EAST · SCMP

China, Egypt expand currency swap as Xi visit concludes

China and Egypt agreed to expand their currency-swap line during Xi Jinping's state visit to Cairo, with a joint statement backing greater renminbi and Egyptian-pound use in trade and investment. SCMP cited experts saying any meaningful shift from dollar reliance will not happen quickly.

INDIA · TAIPEI TIMES

Chinese scientists warn of geological risk at Brahmaputra superdam site

A paper in the state-linked journal Sedimentary Geology and Tethyan Geology warns the site of China's Yarlung Tsangpo superdam, set to dwarf Three Gorges in capacity, has 'loose structure and weak cohesion' and could face catastrophic instability from an earthquake or fault movement. The dam sits near the militarized India border and would impound water above densely populated parts of India's northeast and Bangladesh.

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

TECH / BYTEDANCE · REUTERS

ByteDance secures \$29.6B loan for AI expansion

ByteDance secured a \$29.6 billion loan to fund its AI buildout, Reuters reported Sept. 4, citing sources familiar with the financing.

AUTO / STELLANTIS, HUAWEI, JAC · REUTERS

Stellantis in talks with Huawei, JAC over Maserati partnership

Stellantis is in talks with Huawei and JAC over a potential partnership involving its Maserati brand, Reuters reported Sept. 4, citing sources.

AUTO / VOLVO CAR · WSJ

Volvo Car sales slip on China, US weakness

Volvo Car reported slipping sales attributed to weaker demand in both China and the US, per WSJ.

STAT OF THE DAY

\$29.6B

ByteDance's new AI-push loan

ByteDance secured a \$29.6 billion loan to fund its AI buildout, Reuters reported Sept. 4, underscoring how deeply Chinese tech financing is now tied to the AI race.

Source: Reuters

SSE COMPOSITE

HANG SENG

USD/CNY

3,930.12 ▼ -1.41% as of Sep 5	25,650.87 ▲ +0.26% as of Sep 5	6.7108 ▼ -0.23% as of Sep 5
USD/CNH 6.7070 ▼ -0.14%	BRENT \$96.28 ▲ +6.40%	
Not fetched today: 10Y CGB, China 5Y CDS, PBOC 1Y LPR, PBOC 5Y LPR, GDP · shown only when sourced, never carried forward		
BEIJING		

外交部 · MOFA · *Guo Jiakun, MOFA spokesperson*

MOFA confirms probe into 52 Singaporeans held in Guangxi pyramid-scheme case

Guo Jiakun said China 'handles criminal cases involving foreign nationals in accordance with law' after Singapore's foreign ministry confirmed 52 of its citizens were arrested in Guangxi on suspected multi-level-marketing offenses, calling it possibly the largest such overseas detention of Singaporeans.

→ [MOFA presser ZH / DW ↗](#)

中国人民银行 · PBOC

PBOC rolls over RMB500bn in 3-month reverse repos at same size

The PBOC said it will conduct RMB500 billion in 3-month (89-day) outright reverse-repo operations Sept. 7, maturing Dec. 5, matching the prior round's size and ending two straight months of expansion, a signal economists cited by Eastmoney read as a shift toward liquidity normalization.

→ [PBOC ZH / Eastmoney ↗](#)

商务部 · MOFCOM

MOFCOM reports Brazilian anti-dumping probe into Chinese appliance glass

China's Ministry of Commerce Trade Remedy and Investigation Bureau said Brazilian customs authorities are separately investigating alleged forged certificates of origin and have opened an anti-dumping probe into Chinese-origin tempered glass used in home appliances.

→ [MOFCOM Trade Remedy Bureau ↗](#)

国务院 · STATE COUNCIL · *Li Qiang, Premier*

Li Qiang signs order publishing revised power-safety-accident regulation

Premier Li Qiang signed a State Council order promulgating the revised Regulation on Emergency Response, Investigation and Handling of Power Safety Accidents.

→ [State Council ZH ↗](#)

国台办 · TAIWAN AFFAIRS OFFICE · *Zhang Han, TAO spokesperson*

TAO backs Xiamen's push for Xiamen-Kinmen bridge, cross-strait integration

Zhang Han said the Xiamen-Kinmen bridge is 'the shared aspiration and urgent wish' of people on both sides, after Xiamen announced measures targeting a sea-route opening by end-2026 on its side and a feasibility study for the Kinmen side; Taiwan's Mainland Affairs Council said it has 'no policy or plan' for such a bridge.

→ [TAO ZH \(via Guancha\) ↗](#)

VOICES

FOREIGN AFFAIRS

How Taiwan Can Win the Strait

Taiwan can deter and, if necessary, defeat a Chinese invasion by pairing asymmetric defense investment with societal resilience rather than relying primarily on conventional force parity.

For policy: *Feeds directly into ongoing US-Taiwan debates over arms-sales composition and Taiwan's own defense-budget allocation ahead of the Nov. 28 local elections.*

U.S.-CHINA PERCEPTION MONITOR · JESSICA CHEN WEISS

Coexistence in the New World Order w/ Jessica Chen Weiss

The US-China relationship needs a framework of managed coexistence rather than a zero-sum decoupling strategy, given the two economies' continued interdependence.

For policy: *Relevant context for how the Sept. 24 Xi-Trump summit's outcomes should be judged, as stabilization rather than resolution.*

PROPAGANDA DELTA

The tracker's 85-day Xi-absence flag is stale, People's Daily, CGTN and Ahram Online all confirm his Sept. 3-4 Cairo visit and SCO summit meetings. Watch instead for confirmation of Xi's Sept. 24 Washington itinerary and CEO-delegation size.

DOCTRINAL PHRASE MOVEMENT

Community of Common Destiny / 人类命运共同体 · no baseline — single mention (China-Egypt joint statement)

XI TODAY

Xi Jinping completed a state visit to Egypt (Sept. 3-4), meeting President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi, touring the Grand Egyptian Museum with Peng Liyuan, signing a Belt and Road/Al/trade cooperation package, and meeting Russian, Mongolian and Uzbek leaders around the SCO summit.

PEOPLE'S DAILY FRONT PAGE

'31 dead, 531 missing after mudslide hits border port in China's Xizang' — state coverage frames the Tibet-Nepal border disaster around rescue and resilience rather than casualty scrutiny, consistent with DW/NYT reporting on information controls.

PROPAGANDA FOCUS

China-Egypt 'community of common destiny' diplomacy, disaster-response resilience narrative (Tibet/Jiangxi floods), defensive, non-expansionist military messaging

"As long as they abide by the four China-Japan political documents, pursue a friendly China policy, and value China-Japan relations, we are willing to communicate with them to increase mutual understanding and trust."

Guo Jiakun · 译讯：日中友好议员联盟协调派年轻成员月内访华

Heavy — 140 articles collected (60 direct PRC primary, 83 indirect/citing)

外交部 · MOFA

FIRM · TO OTHER

Defensive national defense policy

Guo Jiakun · MOFA spokesperson

“China firmly pursues a defensive national defense policy and never engages in military expansion.”

中国坚定奉行防御性国防政策，从不搞军事扩张

Context: Statement came amid scrutiny of Chinese military activity, including the contested ballistic-missile launch discussed at this week's Pacific Islands Forum.

MOFA presser ZH / Sina

外交部 · MOFA

CONCILIATORY · TO JAPAN

Japan-China Friendship Parliamentary Union visit

Guo Jiakun · MOFA spokesperson

“As long as they abide by the four China-Japan political documents, pursue a friendly China policy, and value China-Japan relations, we are willing to communicate with them to increase mutual understanding and trust.”

只要能够恪守中日四个政治文件、奉行对华友好、珍视中日关系，我们都愿同他们沟通交流，增进相互理解与信任。

Context: Japan's cross-party 'Japan-China Friendship Parliamentary Union' is coordinating to send young members to China this month, its first such visit since PM Takaichi's November Taiwan remarks froze the channel.

MOFA presser ZH / Kyodo News China

国台办 · TAO

CONCILIATORY · TO TAIWAN

Xiamen-Kinmen bridge and cross-strait integration

Zhang Han · TAO spokesperson

“Building the Xiamen-Kinmen bridge is the shared aspiration and urgent wish of the people of Xiamen and Kinmen.”

建设厦金大桥是厦金两地民众的共同呼声和迫切心愿

Context: Xiamen announced measures targeting a sea-route bridge opening by end-2026 on its side, alongside a study of the Kinmen-side link; Taiwan's MAC said it has no such bridge policy.

Guancha (TAO)

使馆 · Embassy

FIRM · TO OTHER

UK report alleging Chinese farm-tech espionage risk

Chinese embassy spokesperson · Chinese Embassy in the UK

“The so-called 'China spy threat' accusation is utterly baseless and malicious slander, which we strongly condemn. The Five Eyes alliance is the world's largest intelligence organization, and its members are the ones conducting espionage everywhere, they are the real threat to peace-loving nations.”

所谓'中国间谍威胁'指责纯属无中生有、恶意诽谤，我们对此予以强烈谴责……'五眼联盟'是世界最大的情报组织，其成员在世界各地肆无忌惮地进行间谍窃密活动，它们才是爱好和平国家的真正威胁

Context: A UK think tank report claimed Chinese-made connected agricultural machinery, including GPS-guided tractors and drones, could enable intelligence collection on British farms.

外交部 · MOFA

ROUTINE · TO OTHER

52 Singaporeans arrested in Guangxi pyramid-scheme case

Guo Jiakun · MOFA spokesperson

“China handles criminal cases involving foreign nationals in accordance with law, and fully protects the lawful rights of the parties involved.”

中方依法查处在华外国公民违法犯罪案件，并充分保障当事人合法权利

Context: Singapore's foreign ministry confirmed Sept. 4 that 52 of its citizens were arrested in Guangxi on suspected multi-level-marketing offenses.

MOFA presser ZH / DW

WHAT OTHERS ARE SAYING

GUANCHA (风闻) · SEPT 5, 2026

Hu Xijin · Former Global Times editor-in-chief, commentator

“Those who denounce learning English as 'fawning over foreign things' and call for expelling English from schools' core subjects are in fact a rather extreme and narrow-minded bunch.”

Note: Hu Xijin's rebuttal follows a call by an unnamed 'patriotic internet-famous teacher' to strip English of core-subject status in Chinese schools.

source

W I R E

OVERNIGHT FLASH

TECHNOLOGY · SCMP

China launches plan for 3D Earth-Moon satellite network

China's Deep Space Exploration Laboratory launched an international project to build a 3D satellite network between Earth and the Moon to track solar activity and cosmic explosions. The plan calls for 30 backpack-sized CubeSats in highly elliptical orbits over roughly four years.

PLA · 解放军报 (PLA DAILY ZH)

China, Canada hold 5th defense department working meeting

China and Canada held their fifth defense-department working-level meeting on Sept. 4, exchanging views on international and regional issues. Both sides expressed willingness to deepen military exchanges and cooperation, per China's Ministry of National Defense.

INDO-PACIFIC · REUTERS

Chinese national rescued from Nepal tunnel 10 days after flash flood

A Chinese national was pulled alive from a flooded tunnel in Nepal 10 days after the Aug. 26 flash flood, Reuters reported, a day after two Nepali workers were rescued from the same site. China's embassy in Kathmandu confirmed the rescue.

TECHNOLOGY · BLOOMBERG

Kai-Fu Lee says China will win the 'AI reach race'

AI investor Kai-Fu Lee argued China will win the global 'AI reach race' in a Bloomberg video interview published Sept. 4, though the segment did not elaborate on specific metrics.

WHAT WE ARE WATCHING

SEP
9

Mao Zedong death anniversary (50th)

Politically sensitive date; watch for any commemorative propaganda signaling.

SEP
18

Mukden Incident 95th anniversary

Historical flashpoint date for China-Japan tensions.

SEP
22

UNGA high-level week opens, New York

Wang Yi and other senior PRC officials typically address the General Assembly and hold bilateral sidelines meetings.

SEP
24

Xi Jinping state visit to Washington

First Chinese leader state visit to the US since 2015; Trump has confirmed a state dinner and Xi is reportedly bringing a large CEO delegation.

OCT
1

PRC National Day, 77th anniversary

Standard national holiday; watch for any Taiwan Strait signaling around the date.

CSIS KOREA CHAIR · CHINA DAILY BRIEF · GENERATED 9:38 AM ET

This brief is generated automatically from 91 collected sources and may contain errors. Every item links to its source; check the source before citing. Prepared by Andy Lim, CSIS Korea Chair.

[↑ Back to top](#)